

Citing - Repo Summary

One-page overview generated from repo evidence on 2026-03-20.

What It Is

Citing is a citation conversion app and engine for turning messy references into formatted outputs across major academic styles. The repo implements a React frontend, an Express API, a local parsing/rendering pipeline, failure-report tooling, and an optional Chrome capture extension.

Who It's For

Primary persona: academic researchers managing large reference lists; repo docs also mention journal editors and publishers as secondary users. If a narrower production persona exists beyond that, it was not found in repo.

What It Does

- Converts mixed-format references between APA, MLA, Harvard, Chicago, IEEE, and Vancouver.
- Auto-detects input style, parses citation fields, and reformats output through CSL-based rendering.
- Processes references in batches and groups similar items into citation clusters.
- Accepts pasted text plus TXT, PDF, and DOCX uploads for extraction.
- Exports results as TXT, BibTeX, or RIS.
- Scores confidence, supports optional Semantic Scholar authority lookup, and allows per-item recheck.
- Captures references from webpages via a Chrome extension that injects a saved batch into the app.

How It Works

- Frontend: Vite + React + Wouter + TanStack Query in `client/src` renders the converter, history, contact, FAQ, and admin report views.
- Capture path: the extension stores selected references in `chrome.storage.local`, then writes a batch into `app.localStorage` and dispatches a browser event the React app reads.
- API layer: Express routes expose `/api/convert`, `/api/reformat`, export endpoints, file parsing, contact, and report-management APIs.
- Engine flow: `normalize encoding -> pre-normalize -> detect style -> parse -> convert to CSL -> strict render/assert -> sanity check -> confidence -> optional authority enrichment -> clustering`.
- Data/services: converted references are stored in in-memory app storage; failure reports are persisted as JSONL under `data/`; authority lookups call Semantic Scholar when enabled.

How To Run

- Install deps: `pnpm install`.
- Create env file: copy `.env.template` to `.env`; API keys are optional for basic local use.
- Start dev server: `pnpm dev`.
- Open `http://localhost:5000`. Optional: load the unpacked extension/ folder in Chrome for capture testing.

Notes: Architecture and setup statements above are limited to files present in this repo. Items not evidenced in code were marked as not found.